

India officially acceded to the Antarctic Treaty System on 1 August 1983. The program was started with the goal of initiating multiple fields of study in Antarctica. It was decided that a permanent station would be built during the 3rd expedition along with continuation of previous research on the continent.



Their journey began in December 1983. They set sail from Goa and after 1 month of continuous sailing, the team docked at the Schirmacher Oasis region. Dr Pant and Dr Sengupta became the first Indian women to set foot in Antarctica.

The expedition wasn't without its risks. The frozen continent provided quite a challenge to stay at and study. They had to face blizzards, freezing temperatures, and a sun that never set. There were also many technical difficulties during their voyage.



This was not the first challenge faced by the women scientists. Despite prevalent sexism, they had proven themselves through their achievements in research. Sudipta sengupta also had plenty mountaineering experience through previous expeditions.

